

District Onboarding Guide

Welcome to ParentSquare

This guide walks your implementation team through every step of setting up ParentSquare for your district. Complete all steps in Part 1 before your go-live date.

Part 1: Technical Setup (IT Director)

Step 1: SIS Integration

ParentSquare integrates with 80+ Student Information Systems via direct API, SFTP flat file, or CSV import. The recommended method is direct SIS integration for real-time roster updates.

Supported SIS platforms: PowerSchool, Infinite Campus, Skyward, Aeries, Escholar, Tyler SIS, Synergy, Frontline, Skyward Finance, and others.

SIS Integration Steps:

1. Submit a SIS Integration Request in the Help Center.
2. Grant ParentSquare read-only API access or configure SFTP export schedule.
3. Map your student identifier fields to ParentSquare schema.
4. Run test sync with 10–50 records; verify family contact accuracy.
5. Enable nightly full sync or real-time API sync.

Step 2: Contactability Baseline

After your first SIS sync, review your Contactability Score in the admin dashboard. A score below 80% indicates missing phone numbers or email addresses. Common fix: export your parent contact list from your SIS and cross-reference against the Missing Contact report.

Target: 90%+ contactability before go-live.

Step 3: Channel Configuration

- SMS: ParentSquare sends from a dedicated school number. Verify your district's phone number in Settings > School Numbers.
- Email: Configure your district's sending domain (SPF, DKIM, DMARC records). IT must update DNS within 48 hours.
- App: Publish your district app branding (logo, colors) in Settings > App Customization.

Step 4: Staff Accounts

Provision staff accounts via SIS sync or CSV upload. Role types:

- School Administrator: Full access to all school-level settings and messages.
- Teacher: Send classroom updates; view class roster.

- District Administrator: Cross-school visibility, district announcements, reporting.

Part 2: Communications Setup (Communications Director)

Message Templates

Create templates for your most-used message types. Required templates for go-live:

- School Closure / Emergency Notification template.
- Back to School welcome message.
- Attendance Alert (auto-populated if Attendance module is active).

Language Translation

ParentSquare supports 190+ languages via automatic translation. Set your district's default language priority list in Settings > Languages. Families will receive messages in their preferred language automatically.

Emergency Notification Protocol

Before go-live, conduct a test emergency notification drill:

1. Create a test message marked as 'Emergency' type.
2. Send to all channels simultaneously.
3. Verify delivery rates within 5 minutes (target: 85%+ delivered within 2 minutes).
4. Review failure report and update family contact data accordingly.

Part 3: Attendance Setup (if module purchased)

Attendance Integration

ParentSquare pulls attendance data from your SIS daily. Absences are automatically identified and attendance alert messages are triggered based on your configured rules.

Default Rules:

- Same-day absence: Alert sent by 9:00 AM local time if student not marked present.
- Chronic absenteeism threshold: Alert to parent when student misses 10% of school days.
- Unexcused absence pattern: Escalation to counselor at 3 consecutive unexcused absences.

Modify these rules in Settings > Attendance > Alert Configuration.

Part 4: Go-Live Checklist

Complete all items before activating for your full district:

- ☐ SIS sync completed and verified (100% of schools)
- ☐ Contactability Score $\geq$ 90%

- ☐ Staff accounts provisioned and roles verified
- ☐ Emergency notification test drill completed
- ☐ Language settings configured for top 5 district languages
- ☐ School phone numbers confirmed in Settings
- ☐ First parent-facing message drafted and reviewed
- ☐ CSM kickoff call completed